AGES 2–3 · FREE · NO SIGN-UP

# Explore and Discover: toddler learning for ages 2 to 3.

Short, picture-led activities to play together, with a hands-on version of each. Every on-screen game opens straight away, with no account.

## For grown-ups

For ages 2 to 5, the American Academy of Pediatrics suggests about an hour a day of high-quality screen time at most, watched or played with a grown-up.

Our on-screen activities take two or three minutes. Instructions can be read aloud and are always shown as text.

A wrong tap just gets a gentle hint. Nothing is lost and there is no score.

Hands-on play matters more than any app at this age. Each activity has an off-screen version.

8 ACTIVITIES

# Things to do together

Each one has a clear purpose, a way to play, and words to use.

COLORS

## Find the color

On-screen game + off-screen play · About 2 min

**What it builds:** Recognize and name the basic colors.

### You need

- Colored socks, blocks or toys

### How to play

1. Play the short on-screen game together.
2. Then lay out three colored socks and ask for one by color.
3. Swap roles: your child asks you for a color.

### Things to say

*"Can you find the blue one?"*

*"Yes, blue like the sky."*

*"Which one is yellow?"*

### Take it further

Sort laundry by color into piles.

COUNTING

## Count the dots

On-screen game + off-screen play · About 2 min

**What it builds:** Count up to three objects, touching each one once.

### You need

- Three blocks or crackers

### How to play

1. Play the on-screen counting game together.
2. Line up three blocks and touch each one as you count aloud.
3. Ask "How many?" and say the last number together.

### Things to say

*"One, two, three. Three blocks!"*

*"Let's touch each one."*

*"How many crackers do you have?"*

### Take it further

Count stairs out loud as you climb them.

SHAPES

## Shapes into holes

On-screen game + off-screen play · About 3 min

**What it builds:** Match circles, squares and triangles by their outline.

### You need

- A shape sorter, or shapes cut from card with matching outlines drawn on paper

### How to play

1. Drag or tap each shape into its hole on screen.
2. Do the same with card shapes on paper outlines.
3. Name each shape as it fits.

### Things to say

*"Round. That's a circle."*

*"Does it fit? Let's turn it."*

*"The triangle has pointy corners."*

### Take it further

Go on a circle hunt: plates, clocks, wheels.

MEMORY AND MATCHING

## Shape pairs

On-screen game + off-screen play · About 3 min

**What it builds:** Remember where things are and match pairs.

### You need

- Pairs of socks or matching cups

### How to play

1. Play the matching game together, taking turns.
2. Then hide a toy under one of two cups and swap them slowly.
3. Ask which cup the toy is under.

### Things to say

*"Where was the other circle?"*

*"You remembered!"*

*"Which cup is it under?"*

### Take it further

Pair up socks from the laundry.

FIRST LETTERS

## Find the letter B

On-screen game + off-screen play · About 2 min

**What it builds:** Notice that letters have shapes and names, starting with letters that matter to your child.

### You need

- Alphabet magnets or a book

### How to play

1. Play the on-screen game together.
2. Find the first letter of your child's name on cereal boxes and signs.
3. Trace it with a finger.

### Things to say

*"B, like ball and bear."*

*"That's your letter!"*

*"Can you find another B?"*

### Take it further

Trace letters in a tray of rice or sand.

SORTING

## Tidy-up sorting

Off-screen · About 10 min

**What it builds:** Group things by one feature: kind, color or size.

### You need

- Toys to put away
- Two boxes

### How to play

1. Choose one rule: cars in this box, animals in that box.
2. Hand over toys one by one and ask where each goes.
3. Next time, sort by color or by big and small.

### Things to say

*"Is this a car or an animal?"*

*"Big ones here, small ones there."*

*"You sorted them all!"*

### Take it further

Sort spoons and forks when unloading the dishwasher (safe items only).

IMAGINATIVE PLAY AND LANGUAGE

## Teddy's picnic

Off-screen · About 15 min

**What it builds:** Use words for food, sharing and feelings in pretend play.

### You need

- A soft toy or teddy
- Toy or real cups and plates

### How to play

1. Set up a picnic for teddy.
2. Ask your child to give teddy a cup, a plate, one snack.
3. Talk about how teddy feels: hungry, full, happy, sleepy.

### Things to say

*"Teddy is hungry. What shall we give him?"*

*"One for you, one for teddy."*

*"Is teddy happy now?"*

### Take it further

Add a second toy and practice sharing fairly.

FINE MOTOR

## Play dough rolls and pinches

Off-screen · About 15 min

**What it builds:** Strengthen the hand muscles later used for holding a pencil.

### You need

- Play dough
- A blunt plastic knife or cookie cutter

### How to play

1. Roll dough into snakes and balls.
2. Pinch small pieces off and press them flat.
3. Count the balls you made together.

### Things to say

*"Long snake! Short snake."*

*"Squash it flat."*

*"How many balls did you make?"*

### Take it further

Press shapes into the dough with a cookie cutter and name them.

> These activities relate to the Head Start Early Learning Outcomes Framework domains of Language and Communication, Mathematics Development, Perceptual,

> Motor and Physical Development and Approaches to Learning. That is our own mapping, not an official review or endorsement.